

# When the Light Grows Dim

**Some Pastors are not losing their passion.  
They are losing the capacity to carry it.**

You may be the one everyone calls. The one who steps in when someone else can't.

It can be hard to receive care when you're used to being the one who gives it.



**You are not the only one.**

More than

**6 in 10**

U.S. senior Protestant Pastors report feeling emotionally or mentally exhausted **frequently or sometimes**.

You can love Jesus and still be exhausted. You are not failing because you are hurting. Receiving care is not a failure of faith.

## THE HEARTBEAT

When the disciples returned, Jesus heard what they had done and taught. They had not had time to eat. He invited them to come away and rest.

MARK 6:30-32 / PARAPHRASE

**Make room  
to recover.**

Protect rest with someone else actually covering the work.

**Bring care  
close.**

Offer trusted support and qualified professional care when needed.

**Change what keeps  
causing harm.**

Share responsibility and change harmful expectations.

**You do not have to carry this alone.**

You can begin privately, with someone you trust.

Source: Barna Group with Gloom, "Pastors' Sense of Calling Is Up - Satisfaction Is Lagging," May 5, 2026. 2026 survey: 507 U.S. senior Protestant Pastors. Self-reported exhaustion, not a diagnosis; reported exhaustion has declined over the past decade. A conversation about care, not a diagnosis or treatment plan.